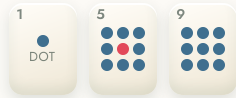


Beginner's *Table Guide*

Everything you need for your first night at the table.

The Tiles — three suits

DOTS ·



Circles, 1–9. Think coins.

BAMS ·



Bamboo sticks, 1–9. The 1 is a bird.

CRAKS ·



Characters, 1–9. “Crak” = (10,000).

Winds & Dragons

WINDS — N E W S



DRAGONS



A Dragon must match its suit's color. Soap (White) also plays as a “0.”

Flowers & Jokers



Flowers are bonus tiles — eight in the set. **Jokers** are wild and stand in for any tile inside a group of **three or more** identical tiles.

No Jokers in a Single or a Pair.

Words you'll hear at the table

The Wall — the stacked tiles everyone builds before play.

The Card — the list of winning hands you're trying to make.

Charleston — the opening rounds of passing tiles to improve your hand.

Pair — two identical tiles. **Pung** — three. **Kong** — four.

Quint / Sextet — five / six identical tiles (Jokers help!).

Call — claim someone's discard to complete part of your hand.

Mahjong! — what you say when your hand is complete. You win.

Wall game — tiles run out with no winner; it's a wash.

How to read your card

Each line is one winning hand. The **colors** on the card aren't the tile colors — they're a map of which groups must be the **same suit** and which must be **different**.

Same color = same suit. Different colors = different suits. A Dragon always belongs to its suit's color.

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Flowers · a run in one suit · a Pung in another.

♦ “X” means concealed · “C” means you may expose. Watch the parentheses — they group the tiles.

From shuffle to *Mahjong!*

The rhythm of a hand, start to finish.

Setting up

- 1 **Build the wall.**
Shuffle face-down. Each player builds a wall in front of her rack — 19 tiles across, two high.
- 2 **Deal the tiles.**
East deals. East takes 14 tiles; everyone else takes 13.
- 3 **Sort your rack.**
Left to right: Jokers, Flowers, suits with matching Dragons, then Winds in N-E-W-S order.
- 4 **Pick your hand.**
Find the line on the card your tiles come closest to. That's your target.

→| The Charleston

Three rounds of passing **three tiles** each, to sweeten everyone's hand before play.

1ST CHARLESTON — REQUIRED

Pass **right**, then **across**, then **left**. (The last left pass can be a *blind* pass.)

2ND CHARLESTON — OPTIONAL

Left, across, right — any player may stop it. Finish with a **courtesy pass** of 0–3 tiles with the player across from you.

Your turn, around the table

- 1 **East starts.**
East discards her 14th tile to open play, naming it out loud.
- 2 **Draw, rack, discard.**
On your turn, draw from the wall, optionally make a Joker exchange, then discard one tile face-up — say its name.
- 1 **Call a discard.**
Need the tile just discarded? Call it, expose the group it completes, then discard. Calling can jump the turn order.
- 2 **Win the hand.**
Complete the 14 tiles of a hand on your card and call “Mahjong!” — the hand is yours.

Quick reminders

-  **When in doubt, count.** Verify a group before you call it.
-  **Parentheses matter.** On the card they group tiles — read them carefully.
-  **Jokers need a crowd.** Only inside groups of three or more.
-  **Walls left, play right.** Turns move to the right around the table.

A table is waiting.

Come learn in person — beginners always welcome. Pick a night & save your seat at mahjongforthegirls.com